

WELCOME!

**33rd Annual Pistahan Parade and Festival
Volunteer Orientation**

July 29 & July 30, 2026

{ Begin Recording }



Agenda

- 1) Welcome! Check-In / Introductions
- 2) About FAAE
- 3) Volunteer Program Overview
- 4) About the Parade
- 5) About the Festival
- 6) Your Volunteer Experience
- 7) Health & Safety
- 8) Q&A
- 9) Wrap
- 10) Next Steps
- 11) Adjournment

Your Name

Fun fact about you

Have you volunteered with Pistahan before?

What are you most looking forward to?



FILIPINO AMERICAN ARTS EXPOSITION PRESENTS
33RD ANNUAL CELEBRATION OF FILIPINO COMMUNITY, CULTURE AND CUISINE

PISTAHAN

PARADE AND FESTIVAL

CELEBRATING
10 YEAR
ANNIVERSARY
SOMA
FILIPINAS

YERBA BUENA
GARDENS
SAN FRANCISCO

AUG 8-9
11 AM - 5 PM
2026

AUG 8
GRAND PARADE
ALONG MARKET ST.
11AM

FREE
ADMISSION
AND OPEN TO
THE PUBLIC



LABAN:
PURPOSE,
POWER,
PRIDE.



SCAN ME



PISTAHAN.NET | FOLLOW US @PISTAHANSF



NO PETS, CERTIFIED SERVICE OR
COMPANION ANIMALS EXCEPTED.

About FAAE

The Filipino American Arts Exposition (FAAE) is an all-volunteer, grassroots, multi-generational, nonprofit organization.

Founded in 1994, our mission is to broaden awareness and deepen the understanding of Filipino American heritage and traditions to spark cultural pride and foster community empowerment.



History



The Filipino American Arts Exposition (FAAE) was founded after more than 4,000 Filipino families were displaced during the redevelopment of the Moscone Convention Center and the Yerba Buena Gardens Complex. The Pistahan Parade and Festival was organized by FAAE in 1994 out of the community's activism to honor, preserve and celebrate the legacy of the Filipino American community's struggles, triumphs and deep roots in San Francisco and SOMA Pilipinas, the new Filipino cultural heritage district in San Francisco. After 33 years, it continues to be a beacon of cultural preservation and celebration.

Festival Overview

Pistahan is the premiere celebration of Filipino community, culture and cuisine. It is the largest Filipino festival in the United States.

Each year, guests look forward to Pistahan as a meaningful way to reconnect with Filipino culture, honor their roots, and celebrate with the community. The festival offers an authentic cultural experience with a vibrant parade, delicious Filipino food, world-class entertainment, and engaging Pavilion activities.

YOU – our volunteers are the backbone of the the Pistahan Parade and Festival. We are deeply grateful for your time, dedication, and positive energy. **THANK YOU** in advance for your efforts and contributions in helping make this year's Pistahan a great success!

Festival Overview

2026 Pistahan Dignitaries:

JESSICA CALOZA (CA Assemblymember)
Hermana Mayor

ARNEL TALISAYON (Consul General)
Parade Community Grand Marshal

SOMA PILIPINAS (10th)
Parade Legacy Grand Marshal

MEL VERA CRUZ
Featured Graphic Artist (poster design)



Volunteer Program Overview

Pistahan Dream Team: **PISTAHAN**



DEVELOPMENT TEAM

- » Al Perez, PM
- » Peter Rojo
- » Michiko Wagner
- » Marco Duldulao

CREATIVE TEAM

- » Al Perez, PM

WEBSITE TEAM

- » Gerard Talampas, PM
- » Franklin Ricarte
- » Rafael Ebron
- » Archie Judan
- » Eric Perez

COMMUNICATIONS TEAM

- » Jay dela Cruz, PM
- » Jaena Cabrera, PM

PHOTOGRAPHY TEAM

- » Eric Perez, PM

SOCIAL MEDIA

- » TBD, PM
- »
- »

EXPO MAGAZINE

- » Anthony Villegas, PM
- » Jaena Rae Cabrera

EVENT SERVICES TEAM

- » Jay Ann Leyson, PM
- » Arlene Rojo, PM
- » Grace Esteban, PM



pistahan
PARADE AND FESTIVAL



Volunteer Program Overview

Pistahan Dream Team: **PARADE**



PARADE DIRECTOR

- » Kevin Benedicto

OUTREACH

- » Kevin Benedicto, PM
- » Tiffany Zhang

REGISTRATION

- » Jake Furagganan, PM
- » Jordan Tirona
- » Brielle Trinidad
- » Grace Esteban

OPERATIONS

- » Geo Reyes, PM
- » Sarah Davis
- » Tonette Queri

DISEMBARKMENT

- » Quentin Johnson, PM

PROGRAMS & VIP

- » Mitchell Foster, PM
- » Kevin Benedicto, PM

Volunteer Program Overview

Pistahan Dream Team: **FESTIVAL**

» Eleanore Fernandez, PM



ART PAVILION

- » Edwin Lozada, PM
- » Ava Ragasa, PM

CULINARY

- » Mick Del Rosario, PM
- » Katrina Wise, PM

DANCE PAVILION

- » Johnny Veloso, PM
- » Elmira Lagundi

HEALTH PAVILION

- » Tim Verceles, PM
- » Archie Judan, PM

INNOVATION PAVILION

- » Fatima Wright, PM
- » Regina Finuliar, PM
- » Archie Judan, PM

SPORTS PAVILION

- » Arnold Cheng, PM
- » Joseph Bautista

HOSPITALITY PAVILION

- » George Bauto, PM
- » Norman Ragasa, PM

ENTERTAINMENT TEAM

- » Em Angeles, PM
- » Eugene Libadia, PM

LOGISTICS TEAM

- » Cyril Sola, PM
- » Joanna Landayan
- » Marco Duldulao

Volunteer Program Overview

33rd Annual Pistahan Parade and Festival
Yerba Buena Gardens and
Yerba Buena Center for the Arts (YBCA)



PARADE: Saturday, August 8 | 11AM - 12PM

FESTIVAL: Saturday & Sunday, August 8 - 9 | 11AM - 5PM

2026 Theme:

“Laban: Purpose, Power, Pride.”

Commemorating the 40th Anniversary of the People Power Movement

Celebrating the 10th Anniversary of SOMA Pilipinas



Volunteer Program Overview

Today's orientation is to provide an overview on Pistahan events, activities and features.

Expect to hear from your Project Manager for a more details.



Volunteer Check-in Process

PARADE:

Volunteer Call Time:

SAT, AUG 8 | 7 AM

Check-in at the Volunteer Booth at
SF Civic Center

FESTIVAL:

Volunteer Call Time: *10 min prior your shift.*

Check-in at the Volunteer Booth at
Yerba Buena Gardens, SF

FRI, AUG 7

LOAD-IN: **1PM – 4PM** (YBCA)

LOAD-IN: **3PM – 6PM** (Yerba Buena Gardens)

SAT, AUG 8 | SUN, AUG 9

SHIFT 1: **8AM – 1PM**

SHIFT 2: **1PM – 6PM**





AS

AR



About the Parade

A colorful display of Filipino pride and a celebration of our dynamic community with festive floats, marching contingents and musical groups along Market Street from the Civic Center to the Yerba Buena Gardens. This is an expression of our community's Pinoy Pride, diversity and solidarity.



Parade Features

- » Ribbon Cutting Ceremony
- » Hermana & Hermano Mayor: **TBD**
- » Community Grand Marshal: **Consul General Arnel Talisayon**
- » Community Grand Marshal: **Asm. Jessica Caloza**
- » Legacy Grand Marshal: **SOMA Pilipinas**
- » 50+Parade Contingents
- » Judging Area
- » Parade Awards:
 - Best Dressed
 - Best Spirit
 - Best Performance
 - Best Overall Contingent
 - Parade Director's Award
 - President's Award

Parade Schedule

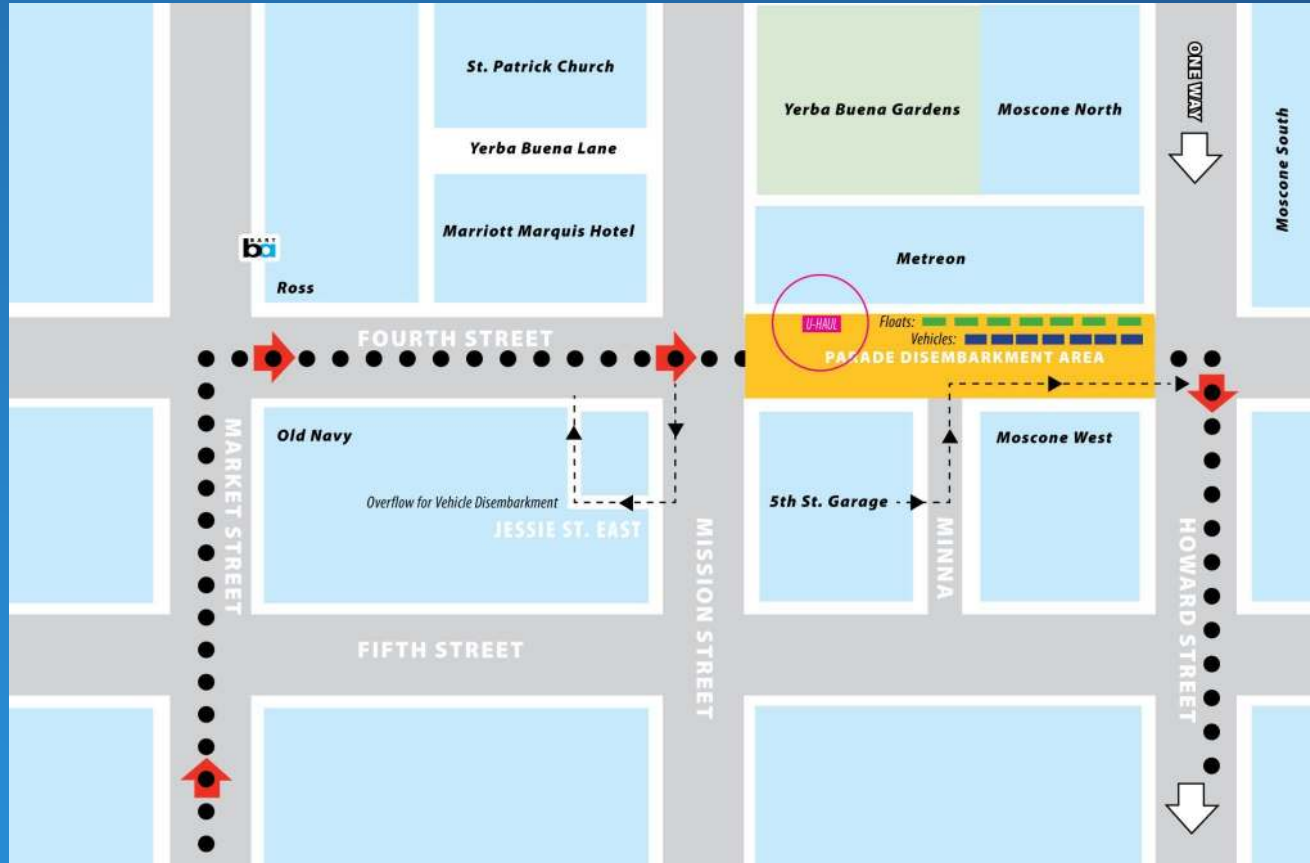
SAT, AUG 8, 2025

- » 7:00 AM Volunteer Call Time
- » 9:00 AM Contingents Call Time
- » 10:00 AM Ribbon Cutting Ceremony
- » 11:00 AM Parade Starts
- » 12:00 PM Parade Ends
- » 3:30–5 PM Parade After Party at YBCA

Parade Assembly Area



Parade Disembarkment Area







Festival Features

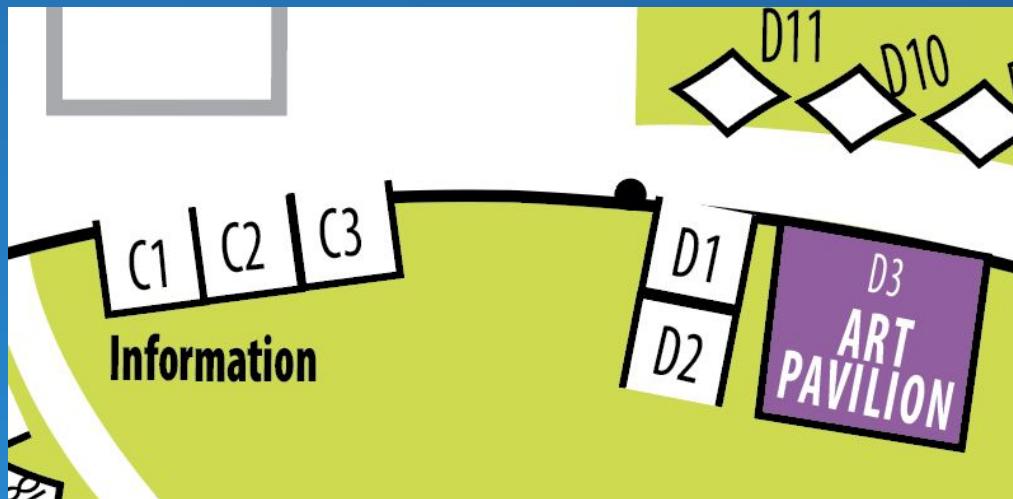
- » Free Admission
- » Live, variety entertainment on the main stage
- » Art Pavilion
- » Culinary Pavilion
- » Dance Pavilion
- » Health Pavilion
- » Innovation Pavilion
- » Hospitality Pavilion
- » Event Services
 - Information Booth
 - First Aid
 - Public Safety

pistachio
Parade and Festival

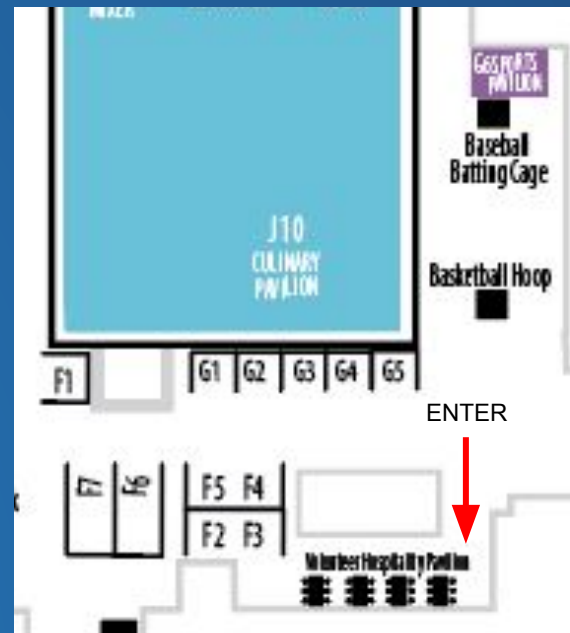


(Not to scale. Subject to change)
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Volunteer Check-in



Hospitality Pavilion

Volunteer Experience

- » Volunteer role, responsibilities
- » Attire:
 - jeans, comfortable shoes (no high heels, open toe shoes)
 - wear layers
- » Lunch at the Hospitality Pavilion
- » Backstage is off limits
- » Volunteer Code of Conduct
- » Escalation Plan
- » Emergency

Volunteer Check-In

- » Arrive at Volunteer Booth 10 min. Prior to your assigned shift
- » Receive a t-shirt, name badge and meal ticket
- » Proceed to your designated volunteer area
- » Report to your Project Manager for tasks and assignments
- » 30 minute lunch break (staggered hours)

GRACE ESTEBAN (PARADE)
(408) 728-6285 | grace.pistahan@gmail.com

JAY ANN LEYSON (FESTIVAL)
(415) 298-3684 | jayann.pistahan@gmail.com



Health & Safety

- » See something, say something!
- » Emergency
- » If you are not feeling well, take a COVID home test.
 - please stay at home if you test positive

Communication Methods

- » **RADIO** — logistics production staff and crew
- » **WHAT'S APP** — Dream Team and Volunteers
- » **CELL** — see “Dream Team” worksheet for a directory of contact information (cell)
- » **PISTAHAN CHECK-IN** — Cell phone app (Grace)

Medical Emergencies

- » **COMMUNICATE** — Call for help
 - » Project Manager
 - » Call 911
 - » First Aid Booth (two locations)
- » **CARE** —
 - » Make guest comfortable and do not move
 - » Assure guest that help is on the way
 - » Respect guest privacy
- » **CONTROL** —
 - » Keep passersby moving
 - » Clear a path for responders
 - » Control the narrative – don't spread misinformation

Evacuations

- » Listen and follow directions from announcements
- » Direct attendees to nearest emergency exits
- » If you can, assist those that need help evacuating
- » Sweep your area
- » Proceed outside the area
- » Go to emergency assembly areas:
 - Carousel area
- » Do not return to evacuated area until you receive the “all clear” notification



Reminders

Our role and goal is to help make this a successful Pistahan cultural experience for our attendees, exhibitors, sponsors, performing artists and guests.

Assist with set-up, strike and execute the program of your assigned pavilion or committee, and support your Project Manager.

Reminders

As an all-volunteer, nonprofit organization, we ask that you treat everyone with **COMPASSION, EMPATHY AND RESPECT.**

If you see something and you are not sure how to engage, ask for assistance from your Project Manager and lead by example by asking, listening, showing up and speaking up for everyone.

Reminders

Teamwork makes the dream work!

Let's support each other, look out for each other, respect fellow volunteers, no drama!

Dynamic event with lots of moving parts... Please be patient and thanks in advance for your flexibility, patience and grace.

Follow us @PistahanSF...

Like, comment and share our social media posts!

Enjoy the experience!

Q & A!

AS

JL